

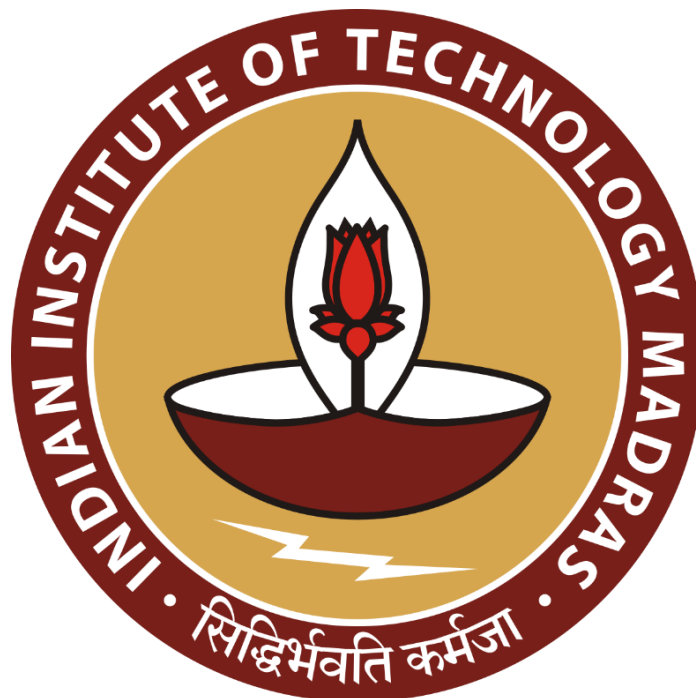
A Business Data Management Report on Sales Insights and Operational Challenges in a Local Bangle and Wool Store

A Proposal report for the BDM capstone Project

Submitted by

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Declaration Statement

I am working on a Project Title “**A Business Data Management Report on Sales Insights and Operational Challenges in a Local Bangle and Wool Store**”. I extend my appreciation to **Naina Kangan and Wool Store**, for providing the necessary resources that enabled me to conduct my project.

I hereby assert that the data presented and assessed in this project report is genuine and precise to the utmost extent of my knowledge and capabilities. The data has been gathered through primary sources and carefully analyzed to assure its reliability.

Additionally, I affirm that all procedures employed for the purpose of data collection and analysis have been duly explained in this report. The outcomes and inferences derived from the data are an accurate depiction of the findings acquired through thorough analytical procedures.

I am dedicated to adhering to the information of academic honesty and integrity, and I am receptive to any additional examination or validation of the data contained in this project report.

I understand that the execution of this project is intended for individual completion and is not to be undertaken collectively. I thus affirm that I am not engaged in any form of collaboration with other individuals, and that all the work undertaken has been solely conducted by me. In the event that plagiarism is detected in the report at any stage of the project's completion, I am fully aware and prepared to accept disciplinary measures imposed by the relevant authority.

I agree that all the recommendations are business-specific and limited to this project exclusively, and cannot be utilized for any other purpose with an IIT Madras tag. I understand that IIT Madras does not endorse this.

Signature of Candidate:

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Vivek Mittal". The signature is written in a cursive style with a horizontal line underneath the name.

Name: Vivek Mittal

Date: December 11, 2025

1 Executive Summary and Title

Project Title: “A Business Data Management Report on Sales Insights and Operational Challenges in a Local Bangle and Wool Store”

This report analyzes sales data and performance of **Naina Kangan and Wool Store**, it is a local bangles and wool business located at New Market, Doiwala, Dehradun (248140), Uttarakhand, serving wholesale bangle clients and retail wool buyers in winter.

The major problems that the business is facing are related to limited market reach, inconsistent sales across seasons, excessive stockholding, low profit margins and manual data-keeping. Due to limited demand and seasonal demand fluctuations, the store often overstocks that leads to tied up capital and slower inventory turnover.

The issues will be addressed by analyzing sales and inventory data trend, seasonal analysis and profit comparison. These approaches will help the business to reduce excess inventory, manage stock efficiently and enhance profitability. Secondly, the store should focus on cost effective marketing. Instead of expensive advertisement, the business can use social media like WhatsApp Business, listing of shop on Google Maps to advertise new variety of products and seasonal offers. Such approaches will help business attract both retail and new wholesale customers.

The expected outcome helps the organization reduce the money blockage in terms of inventory, which helps increase the profitability, and improve overall operational efficiency of the organization.

2 Organization Background

Naina Kangan and Wool Store, located at New Market, Doiwala, Dehradun (248140), Uttarakhand, is a local unorganized retail and wholesale store, dealing in wholesale trade of bangles and retail sale of wool and other related products. The store is solely owned and managed by Mr. Sonit Kumar and his wife, Mrs. Rashmi. They have been running this business for the last 15 years. They started the business by selling only bangles, over time they added wool to maintain sales during winter, when the demand of bangles decreases. The business caters to both wholesale and retail customers, making it a business with B2B-B2C hybrid model. It experiences fluctuations in sales depending on seasons and festivals, with major bangles sales peaks during festivals such as Navratri, Karva Chauth, Rakshabandhan, Eid, Ahoi, and Diwali, and wool during winter season. The business functions largely through traditional methods of keeping sales records and relies heavily on word-of-mouth promotion, repeat customer and long-term relationships with local retails to sustain the customer base. Its reputation for reliable quality and fair pricing has helped it maintain steady sales over the years despite limited digital presence.

3 Problem Statement

- 3.1 **Seasonal Sales Fluctuation:** Seasonal variations in product demand are not supported by proper data analysis as a result, stock and other resource planning are often based on assumptions rather than historical trends, leading to either overstocking or missed sales opportunities.
- 3.2 **Unsystematic Stock Handling:** The business relies on intuition rather than sales data for stock management, causing excess stock of some products and unavailability of other products during high-demand periods.
- 3.3 **Limited Customer Acquisition Channels:** The business depends only on word-of-mouth marketing and lacking customer tracking that restricts the store's ability to expand and measure customer growth or retention.

4 Background of the Problem

Naina Kangan and Wool Store is a small, unorganized bangle and wool store located in New Market, Doiwala, Dehradun, Uttarakhand. The business caters to both retail and wholesale customers. Being an unorganized setup, it operates mostly through traditional methods with manual bookkeeping and not using a digital way to store sales data. While it maintains a steady customer base, the lack of structured planning and informed decision making has led to several operational inefficiencies.

Seasonal Sales Fluctuation: The problem of seasonal sales fluctuation arises because the product demand changes sharply throughout the year, the bangles demand peak during festive seasons and is mostly constant during summer season because of constant sale of it to retailers while wool sees demand in winter. Without proper forecasting and sales analysis, the shop struggles to plan inventory and maintain stable revenue.

Unsystematic Stock Handling: The business relies on manual methods and personal judgement for stock management instead of proper sales records. This causes supply delay, uneven inventory, overstocking of slow-moving products and shortage during peak demand and ultimately low profit.

Limited Customer Acquisition Channels: The business completely depends on word-of-mouth marketing and does not track new or lost customers. This restricts market expansion and makes it difficult to grow. Together, these problems affect business internally. Externally, seasonal dependencies, market competition, low profitability, and further challenges.

5 Problem Solving Approach

To overcome the key issues of seasonal sales fluctuation, unsystematic stock handling, and limited customer accusation, a structured data-driven analytical approach has been designed. The methods selected are easy to implement using MS Excel, making them suitable for a small unorganized business setup.

5.1 Data Collection and system development:

- Standardized record structure: Daily transaction related to sales, purchases, inventory and customer behavior will be recorded in a structured Excel sheets. Daily, weekly and monthly sales record will be used to track income and to understand demand patterns. Purchase data will provide clarity on costs, stock inflow and will help in controlling expenses. Recording inventory helps maintain accurate stock levels and avoid shortages or overstocking.
- Digitalization of manual data: Existing manual data will be transferred into digital, structured format using tools like Excel or Google sheets for easier data storage, tracking and long-term analysis.
- Customer data recording: Customer interaction will be tracked for both retail and wholesale segments. It will be used to analyze buying patterns, customer preferences which improves marketing and business decisions.

5.2 Business Condition Assessment:

Descriptive data analysis will be used to analyze the past business data and assess the existing demand, sales and customer behavior patterns. The objective is to transform raw sales and customer data into meaningful business insights.

- Analysis of sales trends and seasonal patterns:
Monthly and seasonal sales data will be studied using pivot tables, charts and graphs to detect recurring demand cycles, changes in revenue, busy period and slow phases. This will help understand how bangle sales depend on festivals and wool sales increase during winter, showing a clear demand pattern.
- Product-wise sales analysis:
Product-wise sales will be analyzed to identify fast-moving, slow-moving, and low-demand items.

5.3 Inventory Classification and Demand Analysis:

Predictive analytics will be applied to forecast future demand and improve operational planning.

- Stock planning using ABC-XYZ models:
To overcome the issue of unsystematic stock holding and to ensure scientific inventory classification and efficient stock allocation, the combined ABC-XYZ analysis will be implemented.
 - ABC Analysis will help in categorizing items based on their sales value and revenue contribution and XYZ analysis will help in prioritizing investment in high-value and high-demand products.
The combined ABC-XYZ analysis will help identify high priority products,

unstable demand products and overstock prone products, enabling more accurate inventory management planning.

5.4 Customer reach and retention:

- Customer Reach:
Low cost tools such as WhatsApp business and Google business profile will be formed to increase local visibility, provide store location and attract more customers.
- Customer Retention:
Purchasing behavior of regular wholesale and retail customers will be evaluated using RFM analysis. This will help in identifying loyal, occasional and less active customers. The insights obtained will support targeted retention strategies and help align demand forecasting with customer buying patterns.

5.5 Details about tools used:

For data management, Microsoft Excel will be the primary tool for recording daily sales, purchases, inventory, and customer behavior in structured format. Built-in tools such as data filtering, pivot tables, charts and conditional formatting will be used for analyzing the data. Additionally, WhatsApp business will be used as customer communication tool and Google Business Profile will serve as an insight tool, it will provide insights like reviews, and online engagement. Together, these tools will create a simple yet effective data management system that supports accurate record-keeping and better decision-making for the business.

6 Expected Timeline

6.1 Work Breakdown Structure:

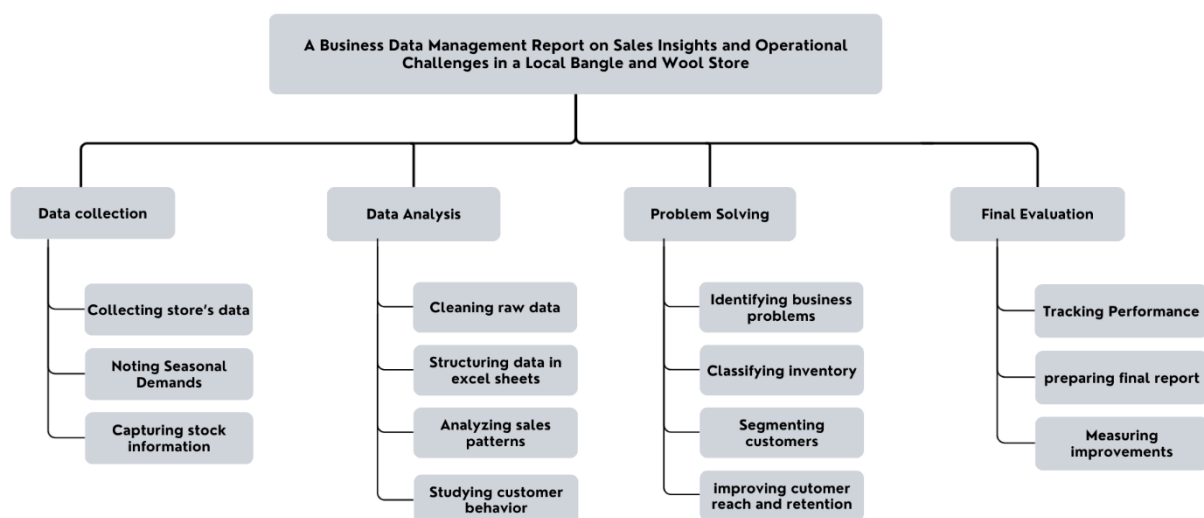


Figure 1: Work breakdown structure

6.2 Gantt Chart:

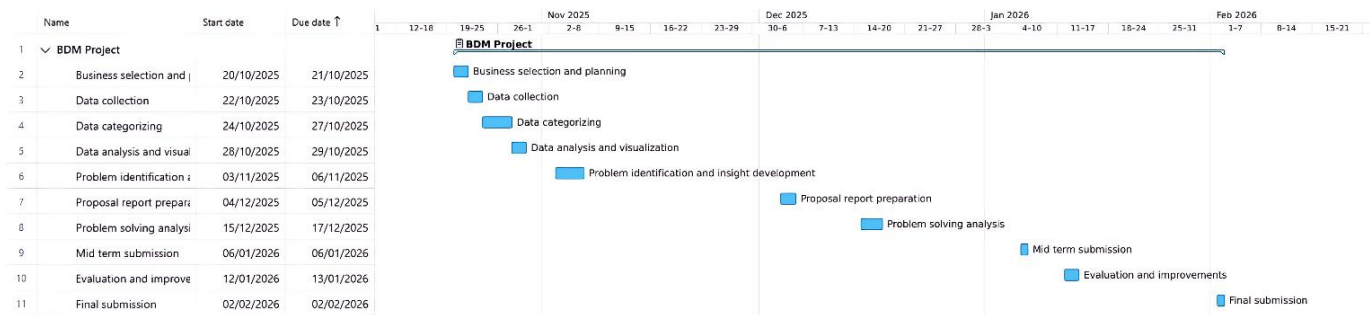


Figure 2 Expected timeline for completion of project.

7 Expected Outcome

The expected outcome of this project is to gain a complete understanding of the sales trends of the store. The findings will help identify which products are in high demand and which ones contribute less to revenue that will help in inventory management.

Using these insights, the store can plan purchase of stock more effectively and can reduce dead stock. The project also aims to provide better market reach without spending any money to attract more customers.

Overall, it will help the business improve its performance, reduce unnecessary costs, and increase overall growth.